

Communication Check-In

Say what you mean. Listen for what they mean.

BEFORE I SPEAK

- What am I actually feeling beneath my frustration?
- What do I need my partner to understand?
- Am I trying to connect — or trying to win?

SAY IT CLEARLY

- I feel _____ when _____ because _____.
- What I need from you is _____.
- What I want us to work on together is _____.

LISTENING CHECK

- Can I repeat what my partner is saying before responding?
- What might they be feeling underneath their words?
- What can I validate even if I disagree?

RESET

- Something I should stop saying during conflict: _____.
- A better way I can express it: _____.
- One conversation we can have when we're both calm: _____.

GO DEEPER

Healthy communication isn't about never disagreeing. It's about making room for both people to be heard.